ST. PAUL'S UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST • OPEN AND AFFIRMING

Worship Service

Easter Sunrise Service

Sunday, April 5, 2026 | 6:30 AM

WE GATHER

- **We Gather Outside at the Easter Fire** — Everyone receives a candle to be lit from it.
- **Easter Proclamation** — Rev. Dr. Dietmar Plajer
  We Share the Light of Christ — we pass the light with these words:
  "Christ is risen!"
  "Christ is risen indeed!"

🎵 **Procession into the Dark Sanctuary** — *"There is a Fountain"* by William Cooper and "The Old Rugged Cross" by George Bernard — Micah Kammerer

- **Call to Worship**
  Leader: Christ is risen!
  All: Christ is risen indeed!
  Leader: Let us celebrate the living God who conquers death.
  All: Christ is risen indeed! Alleluia!

𝄞 **Hymn of Praise — #232** *"Jesus Christ Is Risen Today"* — (verses 1, 2, 4)
Please extinguish the candles.

- **Prayer of Confession** — (in unison)
  God of new creation, thank you for raising us with Jesus to a new life. We are in awe of your power to renew and transform us. Your hope, love, and joy flood our souls. Your music lifts our spirits. Yet the powers of darkness still grab hold of us. We often feel limited and stuck. Help us emerge from our confining cocoons, unfurl our wings, and take flight. Transform us through the power of your love. Mold us and shape us into the image of Christ. We share with you what is on our hearts. (Silence for personal prayer and reflection)

𝄞 **Kyrie — #695** *"Change My Heart, O God"* — (refrain, verse, refrain)

- **Assurance** — Pastor Dietmar

𝄞 **Gloria — #243** *"Be Not Afraid"* — (sing twice)

WE SHARE THE WORD

🎵 **Easter Music** — *"You Are Crowned with Many Crowns"* by John Sellers — Micah Kammerer

- **Scripture Readings** — Shane Sanders
  Prayer of Illumination
  Hebrew Scripture: Jeremiah 31:1–6
  Gospel: Matthew 28:1–10

- **Scripture Reading Response** — *"This is God's Word for the People of God"*
- **Message/Sermon** — *"My Religion Is Love"* — Pastor Dietmar

WE RESPOND WITH THANKSGIVING

- **Hymn of Thanksgiving** — **#250** *"Hymn of Promise"* — (all 3 verses)
- **Offering Announcement**
- **Offering of Music** — *"When I Look into Your Holiness"* by Wayne & Cathy Perrin — Micah Kammerer
- **Doxology** — **#607** *"Praise God from Whom All Blessings Flow"*

HOLY COMMUNION

- **Invitation**
- **Communion Song** — **#497** *"Bread of Life From Heaven"* — (refrain, verse 3, refrain)
- **Consecration and Prayer**
- **Words of Institution**
- **Sharing of the Bread and Cup** — (soft music is welcome as we commune)
  Communion servers — Shane Sanders, Pastor Dietmar

PRAYER

- **The Lord's Prayer**
- **Prayers of the People**

WE ARE SENT

- **Hymn of Mission** — **#245** *"Christ the Lord Is Risen Today"* — (verses 1, 2, 4)
- **Blessing** — Pastor Dietmar
- **Benediction Response** — **#43** *"You Who Dwell in the Shelter of the Lord"* — (refrain only)
  We invite you to hold hands during this song. Hand sanitizer is available in the foyer.
- **Postlude** — *"He Lives"* by Alfred Ackley — Micah Kammerer

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Greeters: Please hand out candles to everyone present. Make sure that latecomers receive a candle.